Terminal + Claude Code

AI Bootcamp — Session 1

Emily Beam

2026-04-22

Terminal + Claude Code

What you're seeing

1. **A terminal app** — where you type commands
2. **Claude Code** — an AI assistant that runs in the terminal
3. Type a request → AI responds → iterate

Key ideas:

- AI can **read and write files** on your computer
- **Iterate**: "Make it shorter," "Add a section on X"
- Output is **Markdown** — readable as plain text or rendered nicely

Quick Markdown overview

Markdown files are simple plain-text documents that use light formatting marks like `#` for headers and `–` for bullets.

- AI tools often write in **Markdown** by default
- It is a good **working output format** because it is lightweight and easy to edit
- Markdown can be converted into **Word files, PDFs, web pages, and slides**
- You do **not** need to know Markdown syntax for this bootcamp

The practical point is just: the AI may hand you a `.md` file, and that is normal.

Raw Markdown vs rendered Markdown

Raw file

getting-started-terminal-tools.md

```
# Getting Started: Ghostty, Zellij, and Oh My Zsh

A quick guide to what each tool does, how they layer together, and the minimum you need to get productive.

---

## How these three tools fit together

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────┐
│  Ghostty          — the terminal app     │
│  ┌──────────────────────────────────────┐│
│  │  Zellij        — splits & sessions   │
│  │  ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  │
│  │  │ Pane 1       │  │ Pane 2       │  │
│  │  │ (zsh + OMZ)  │  │ (zsh + OMZ)  │  │
│  │  └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  │
│  └──────────────────────────────────────┘│
└──────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

- **Ghostty** replaces Terminal.app or iTerm2. It's the window you open.
- **Zellij** runs *inside* Ghostty. It gives you split panes, tabs, and persistent sessions.
- **Oh My Zsh** runs inside each shell. It makes your prompt prettier and adds shortcuts.

They don't conflict — each operates at a different layer.

---

1. Ghostty (terminal emulator)

What it is
A fast, GPU-accelerated terminal app for macOS. Replaces Terminal.app or iTerm2.

How to use it
- **Open it**: Launch from `/Applications/Ghostty.app` (Spotlight: type "Ghostty")
- **Set as default**: System Settings → Desktop & Dock → Default terminal application → Ghostty
- That's it — you just use it like you used Terminal.app. Everything else (zsh, commands, etc.) works the same
inside it.

Key shortcuts
Action	Shortcut
New window	`Cmd+N`
New tab	`Cmd+T`
Split right	`Cmd+D`
Split down	`Cmd+Shift+D`
```

Rendered preview

Getting Started: Ghostty, Zellij, and Oh My Zsh

A quick guide to what each tool does, how they layer together, and the minimum you need to get productive.

How these three tools fit together

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────┐
│  Ghostty          — the terminal app     │
│  ┌──────────────────────────────────────┐│
│  │  Zellij        — splits & sessions   │
│  │  ┌──────────────┐  ┌──────────────┐  │
│  │  │ Pane 1       │  │ Pane 2       │  │
│  │  │ (zsh + OMZ)  │  │ (zsh + OMZ)  │  │
│  │  └──────────────┘  └──────────────┘  │
│  └──────────────────────────────────────┘│
└──────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

- **Ghostty** replaces Terminal.app or iTerm2. It's the window you open.
- **Zellij** runs *inside* Ghostty. It gives you split panes, tabs, and persistent sessions.
- **Oh My Zsh** runs inside each shell. It makes your prompt prettier and adds shortcuts.

They don't conflict — each operates at a different layer.

---

1. Ghostty (terminal emulator)

What it is

A fast, GPU-accelerated terminal app for macOS. Replaces Terminal.app or iTerm2.

How to use it

- **Open it**: Launch from `/Applications/Ghostty.app` (Spotlight: type "Ghostty")
- **Set as default**: System Settings → Desktop & Dock → Default terminal application → Ghostty
- That's it — you just use it like you used Terminal.app. Everything else (zsh, commands, etc.) works the same inside it.

Context and iteration

Context window: The AI only “sees” what you show it. Be explicit.

Iteration tips:

- First output is a draft, not a final product
- Refine: “Change the tone,” “Add an example,” “This is wrong because…”
- Save to a file so you can pick up later

When it’s wrong: AI makes confident-sounding mistakes. Always review output, especially numbers and citations.

Wrap-up

Before next time (April 27)

- Try using an AI tool for **one real task** this week
- Think of a research or teaching task you'd like to automate
- Install guide: eabeam.github.io/uvmecon-ai/prep.html

Next session: Research pipelines, web scraping, automated grading

Resources

- Bootcamp site: eabeam.github.io/uvmecon-ai
- Claude Code docs: docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code
- UVM Copilot (free): go.uvm.edu/copilot